

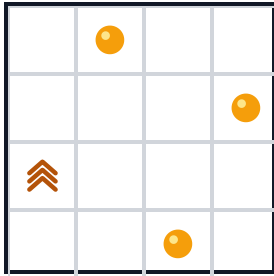


# GOBBLE

SIMULTANEOUS-PROGRAMMING SNAKE · 2-6 PLAYERS · ~20 MIN

Everyone programs their moves **in secret**, then all the snakes move **at once**. Eat to grow. The longer your snake, the more points it's worth!

## What's in the box



**Mini-board** — one per player. Food spots and boost spaces are **printed**: they never run out.



**Your hand:** 6 movement cards + your own permanent boost (left, in your colour). Gold boosts are drawn from the deck and discarded after use.

- **6 mini-boards** (4×4). Every board's food layout is different and rotationally asymmetric — turning a board changes the game. Four boards also carry a **boost space**.
- **Movement cards** — 6 per player, in their colour. Rotate one to aim it.
- **1 personal boost card** per player — always yours, back in hand every round.
- **Boost deck** — generic ×3 boosts you draw from boost spaces and growth milestones.
- **Player board** each — your length track and what each length is worth.
- **Score track** (1–100) and a marker per player.
- **Snake pieces** — 1 head + up to 13 body segments per player.
- **Snake food** — yellow glass beads, left behind when a snake dies.
- **A 10-second timer** — phone or sand.

## The pieces at a glance



**Food spot**  
printed · +1 segment



**Boost space**  
printed · draw 1 boost card



**Snake food**  
from a death · +2 segments, one-shot



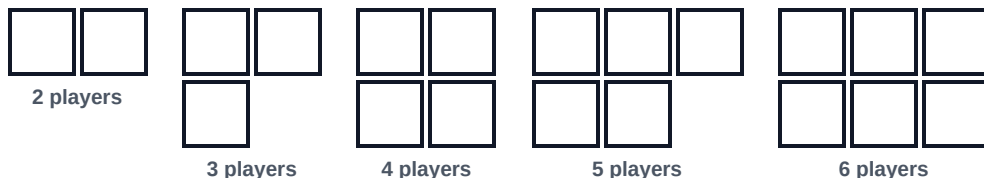
**Head**  
leads the snake · the point shows its facing



**Body segment**  
leaves snake food when you die

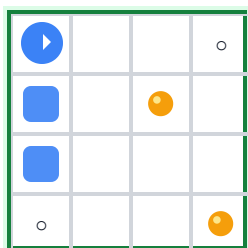
## Setup

- 1 **Build the board.** Put out one mini-board per player, packed as close to an even square as possible. Any outside edge — including the notch where a board is missing — is a **wall**.
- 2 **Deal hands.** Each player takes their 6 movement cards, their personal boost card, their snake pieces and a player board. Shuffle the gold boost deck into a draw stack. Put every score marker off the track (0 points).
- 3 **Place snakes** at length 3 (see below), in any order you like.

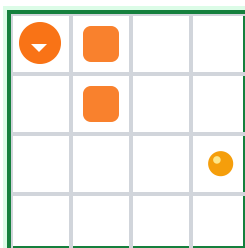


## Placing your snake

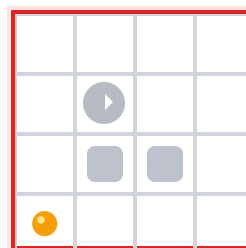
Your snake is **3 segments** on **3 contiguous** cells — straight or bent. At least one of them must **touch a corner of any mini-board** (the ringed cells below). The head goes on one end and simply points away from its neck. You may cover printed food — **you never eat what you cover**.



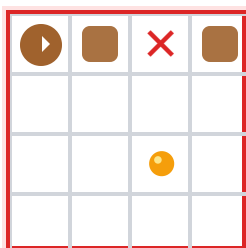
**Legal** — the tail end sits on a corner cell.



**Legal** — bends are fine, and the head is on the corner.



**Illegal** — nothing touches a corner.



**Illegal** — the three cells are not contiguous.

**Respawning** works exactly the same way — a snake that died comes back next round at length 3, on any 3 contiguous cells touching a board corner, avoiding snakes and snake food. If **no corner placement is available at all**, place as close to a corner as you can.

# Playing a round

## 1 • Program, in secret

Lay **2 to 6 cards** face-down in a row in front of you. The leftmost resolves first. Rotate a card to aim it. If you lay fewer than 6, your snake simply **stops in place** for the rest of the round.



Four programmed moves: up, up, a **boost** (3 cells right, rotated), right — then two slots standing still.

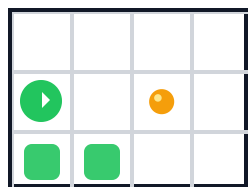
🕒 **The panic timer.** The instant the **first** player finishes their row, start the 10-second timer. When it runs out, everybody else locks **whatever they have** — finished or not. Fast programming is a weapon.

## 2 • Reveal and resolve, one slot at a time

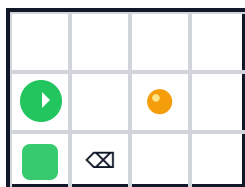
Flip every row face-up. Resolve slot 1 for everyone, then slot 2, and so on. Inside a single slot:

- 1 **Boosts slide first.** Every boosting snake moves its full 3 cells, one cell at a time, together.
- 2 **Then movement cards.** Every stepping snake moves 1 cell, all at the same time.

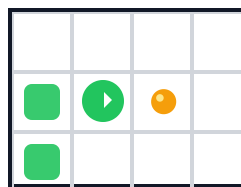
And each individual move happens in this order:



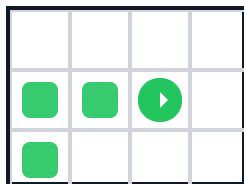
a. Before the move.



b. Tail clears. Lift your last segment — unless this move will grow you.



c. Head slides one cell, and the lifted segment fills the gap behind it.



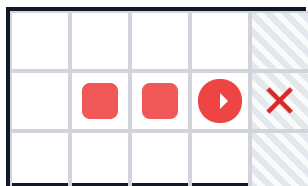
d. Eat. Landing on food adds a segment — the printed spot stays for next time.

## 3 • End of the round

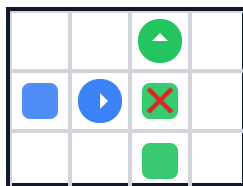
There is **no upkeep** — the food is printed on the boards and never needs replacing. Respawn anyone who died, check whether anybody has hit the target score, and program the next round.

# Crashing

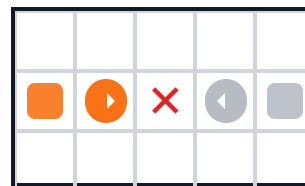
If a snake head moves into a wall, any snake's body, into the same space another snake head is moving into, or into the head of an unmoving snake, **that snake dies**. Your own body counts. The red X marks the cell where the crash happens.



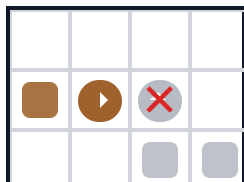
**Wall.** The board edge — or the hatched gap where no board was placed — kills you.



**Body.** Blue drives into green's middle. **Only blue dies** — green is untouched.

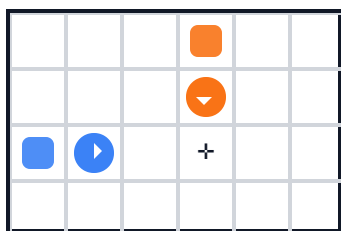


**Same space.** Two heads moving into the same space in the same instant — **both die**.

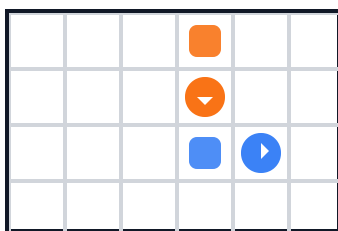


**Into an unmoving head.** Silver programmed no move this slot, so **only brown** — the one that moved — dies.

**Boosts go first, and that matters.** A boosting snake crosses a contested space **before** a stepping snake reaches it — and leaves its body sitting in the way.



**1 · Before.** Blue plays a **boost** (3 cells right). Orange plays a single move down. Their paths cross at the marked space.



**2 · The boost slides first,** straight across orange's path — and blue's **body** now fills the crossing space.



**3 · Then the steppers move.** Orange moves down into blue's body and **dies**, leaving snake food behind. **Blue is unharmed.**

A boost is checked cell by cell: if it crashes on the 1st or 2nd cell it dies there and never finishes the slide.

# Eating & growing

| YOU ENTERED                                                                                          | GROWTH      | BOOST CARDS   | NOTES                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>Food spot</b>   | +1 segment  | —             | Printed — <b>never runs out</b> . A snake sitting on it just blocks it. |
|  <b>Boost space</b> | —           | <b>draw 1</b> | Printed on 4 of the 6 boards — also never runs out.                     |
|  <b>Snake food</b>  | +2 segments | —             | A yellow bead left by a death. <b>One-shot</b> — take it once eaten.    |

New segments appear **behind the head** and unspool as you move. Anything that doesn't grow you resolves like a normal move — your tail piece just fills the gap.

**Growth milestones** — every time your snake **reaches an even length** (4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14), take an extra boost card from the deck. Those lengths are marked with  on your player board. You may hold at most **6** drawn boost cards (your personal one is always on top of that).

## Your player board

Move a marker along it as you grow. The number under each space is what you **bank if you die at that length**.

123456789101215



length 3 → 14 · the gold space is maximum length

**The moment you reach maximum length (14) you bank 15 points immediately** — take them on the score track right away. Your snake stops growing, and from then on every food you eat scores **+2 points on the spot** (snake food scores **+4**).











A maxed snake about to eat...







+2

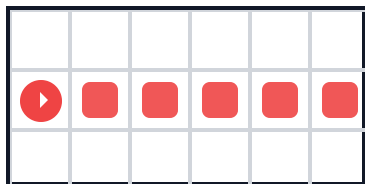




...doesn't grow, and scores +2 on the spot. The food spot is still there for the next pass.

## Dying

- 1 **Bank your length** — the number under your current space on the player board (length 3 = 1 point, up to length 14 = 15). If you already banked by reaching **maximum length**, you score nothing more.
- 2 **Leave snake food.** Your head leaves the board. Put a **yellow bead** on **every other body segment** — the first one behind the head, then every second one after it — and remove the segments in between. Each bead is worth **×2 food** to whoever eats it.
- 3 **Respawn** next round at length 3, touching a board corner (see Setup).



A red snake at length 6 — about to crash.



It banks 4 points and leaves **3 beads of snake food** — every other segment. The rest go back in the box.

## Winning

The moment anybody reaches **50 points**, the game ends immediately — but it isn't over yet:

- **Every snake still alive cashes out**, banking points for its current length off the same ladder (a snake that already banked at maximum length scores nothing more).
- Compare totals. **Highest total wins.**

Crossing the line first does **not** guarantee the win — a rival sitting on a huge live snake can leapfrog you on the cash-out.

*Ties:* whoever ate the most food this game takes it; still tied, share the victory.

## Quick reference

- 1 **Program** 2–6 cards face-down. Movement = 1 cell · Boost = 3 cells. Your own boost comes back every round; drawn ones are discarded.
- 2 The first player to lock starts the **10-second timer**; everyone else locks whatever they have when it ends.
- 3 **Resolve slot by slot:** boosts slide first, then all steppers move together. Tail clears → head slides → check crashes → eat.
- 4 **Food** +1 segment (never runs out) · **boost space** draw 1 · **snake food** +2 segments. Even lengths draw a boost card. Reaching **max 14** banks **15 points**, then every food is worth **2**.
- 5 **Crash** = death: bank your length, leave snake food on every other segment, respawn on a corner next round.
- 6 **First to 50** ends it — living snakes cash out, highest total wins.

**Three habits of a good Gobbler:** program a safe pair of moves before you program a greedy one; watch which rivals still hold boost cards; and never let a fat snake wander somewhere it can't turn around.